LVNA
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VOLUME 64 EDITION 10 OCTOBER 2021 REPRESENTING 1,614 HOUSEHOLDS

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NEXT MEETING

Join us for a virtual discussion with Wendy Silver, librarian with Sunnyvale Public Library, on a variety of offerings, both in person and virtual, from Sunnyvale Public Library. Additionally, Wendy will be providing updates on the Lakewood branch library, underway right here in our neighborhood.

Wednesday, October 13, 7:00 – 8:00 PM

Meeting sign-in link will be posted to LVNASV.org/meeting one hour before the start of the meeting.

Please note, we have changed our meeting platform from Zoom to Google Meet. Google Meet is available on both Android and iOS, but also offers a browser-based interface. If you would like to join through a mobile device, we recommend downloading the app prior to the start of the meeting.

LVNA PUMPKIN CARVING PARTY

Our esteemed volunteer event coordinator is working on the plans for a fantastically spook-tacular pumpkin carving party at either Lakewood or Fairwood Park. Dates are being confirmed with the city so please stay tuned and keep a close eye out for more details to come in the next couple weeks. Get those pumpkins and costumes ready!

MEET YOUR BOARD MEMBER

LYDIA FOTIADES

Lydia is the president of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association.



Q: Tell me a bit about yourself and your family.

Lydia: I married my husband two years ago. We've been together for 13 years. It's the two of us, and we have two cats (Apple and Banana). Those are the names from the shelter. We tried to find better names, but gave up after two weeks and kept their original names.

Q: When did you move to the neighborhood?

Lydia: We moved to this neighborhood at the beginning of 2016.

Q: Where in the neighborhood do you live?

Lydia: I live near Lakewood Park

Q: Name one thing you see out of your kitchen window.

Lydia: My neighbor's fence and the top of their patio.

Q: Something that is in your front yard?

Lydia: There's not much in my front yard…

Q: A sound you hear frequently in the neighborhood?

Lydia: Laughter from kids at the park, and music from people having picnics at the park. It's the sound of people having a good time, which makes me happy.

Q: What is something you like about living in Lakewood/Fairwood? And something that has changed since you moved to the neighborhood.

Lydia: I like that our neighbors are low-key and friendly. Not much has changed since we moved here.

Q: What are your favorite parks/things to do in Sunnyvale and/or the Bay Area?

Lydia: I love to go for bike rides to Shoreline Park and back. It's about 20 miles roundtrip, and sometimes when I get to Shoreline Lake, I'll do a run around the lake, which is about two miles. I love the bike trails in this area! I can take the greenbelt and get all the way to Shoreline Lake from there. I barely have to go on any actual roads to get there. I can get to Levi Stadium by bike trail and Mercado on my bike. I love the accessibility that we have here – I can even bike to the salt ponds.

Q: Tell me a bit about your hobbies.

Lydia: Lately, I enjoy running, but this has been recent since covid. Before covid, I hated running. But now I've been forced into it since it's the only form of cardio I can do with covid around, but I've started to really enjoy it. I also like taking drives, like driving Skyline Boulevard. You start in Saratoga and end up in Foster City (and then come back down 280). It's a great chance to listen to music and clear my head, similar to what I get from running. I also love road trips and will do long drives around the Bay Area.

Q: Any great stories to share about living in the neighborhood?

Lydia: Most of the stories are just related to what I've already talked about – I love having Lakewood Park nearby and easy access to the bike trails.

Q: How did you get involved with the LVNA initially?

Lydia: A few years ago, I had spoken to the then-president about doing the LVNA picnic, since I hadn't seen any information about the picnic. One of the first things I remember about moving here was getting a flier in the mail about the picnic. I told my husband we should go, we did, we met some people, we ate good food, and we even won a raffle for two movie tickets. So I inquired about the picnic and was told it was tough to get volunteers to help, so my husband and I ended up coordinating the picnic entirely on our own that year (this was July of 2018), including passing out fliers to all of the houses in the neighborhood. So that's how I got involved, and my volunteering was noticed by other board members, who convinced me to join.

Q: Why did you want to be president?

Lydia: No one else was interested, and I didn't want LVNA to dissolve completely. I've always said that, if anyone else wants to be president, I'm happy to pass that along. Until then, I do as much as I have the capacity to do. I would really like to have more people involved in the events that we do. The events are what make me want to stay involved and active. There are many reasons to be on the board – change things, etc. I just want to be involved in the social event, and to help with dumpster day, holiday events, etc.



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FREE SCHOOL MEALS FOR ALL CALIFORNIA SCHOOL CHILDREN

Many of us may not be aware that, in addition to all the other ways covid has disrupted our lives, the pandemic resulted in significant changes to how school meals are funded. Previously, school districts across the United States were reimbursed by the USDA (United States Department of Agriculture) for school meals as part of the National School Lunch Program (NSLP); reimbursement amounts were on a sliding scale based on the student's free or reduced-price meal (FRPM) status. In the 2019-2020 school year, 63% of California's students (3.9 million children) participated in the NSLP. With the onset of the pandemic, the USDA policy changed to reimburse schools for all school meals (regardless of the income of a student's family). Earlier this year, the USDA announced that it will extend the broader reimbursements through the 2021-2022 school year. While that was wonderful news to families across the US, it left many wondering what would happen in the 2022-2023 school year and beyond.

In California, access to free meals for students will continue - the Universal Meals Program was included in the state budget that the California State Legislature and Governor Gavin Newsom signed in June. The funding will cover school meals in the 2022-2023 academic year, and it comes from larger-than-expected projected revenues (in other words, surplus tax dollars collected from California residents) to provide $650 million annually to reimburse schools for the meals.

Why is feeding our students so important? There is a proven link between hunger and learning - kids who are hungry do not learn as well as kids who are not hungry. As Alia Wilson, the Communications Coordinator at the Sunnyvale School District (SSD), says, "When we take care of students' basic needs, they are free to focus on learning and growing and having fun!" The SSD covers Sunnyvale's 8 elementary schools and two middle schools, and the district is providing free meals to all students for the 2021-2022 academic year through the Seamless Summer Option program provided by the USDA.

We spoke with Alia to learn more about these programs and how they help SSD and its students. The conversation below is edited for clarity and length.

Q: What meals do students get?

Alia: We provide students breakfast, lunch, snack, and dinner.

Q: Do families still have to fill out paperwork to qualify for the free meals?

Alia: Yes, we still ask families to fill out the FRPM paperwork, even though they do not have to pay for the meals. The paperwork helps them qualify for other financial assistance, such as p-ebt cards (you can find more information about p-ebt cards here: https://www.cdss.ca.gov/home/pandemic-ebt). Additionally, SSD funding that we get from the state is based on how many students qualify for FRPM. Getting families to complete the paperwork is also important because it will help us with funding in the future if or when free lunches end.

Q: How many free meals are served each day?

Alia: Across our whole district (10 schools), about 26% of students are socio-economically disadvantaged. Under the old rules, these students would have qualified for FRPM. Under the new rules, all of our students get free meals. We serve about 4184 free school meals each day.

Q: How many food service workers work in SSD?

Alia: Districtwide, we have 29 food service workers, 2 delivery drivers, and 2 office support staff members.

Q: Tell me a bit about the food students get.

Alia: Our food services contract is with Sodexo, and all students receive the same meal. They get breakfast, a hot lunch, a snack, and a frozen supper entree to take home. The after-school program receives a hot supper entrée and snack. We get locally grown produce when available. You can find more about our partnership with Sodexo here: https://sunnyvalesd.sodexomyway.com/

Q: Anything else to add?

Alia: Yes, we are so happy to be able to provide this important and needed resource for our families!

References:

https://edsource.org/2021/usda-extends-free-meals-through-next-school-year/653335

https://edsource.org/2021/free-school-meals-here-to-stay-in-california/658564

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MEET YOUR NEIGHBOR

Please email vp2@lvnasv.org if you want to recommend someone for an upcoming newsletter or if you would like to interview a neighbor for the newsletter.

SARAH OWENS



Q: Tell me a bit about yourself and your family.

Sarah: My husband Conley and I have been married for 11 years, and we have 7 children! Our oldest is 10, and the youngest is 15 months old. Conley is a software engineer at Google and a part-time pastor at the church in Lakewood Village (Silicon Valley Reformed Baptist Church). I am able to stay at home and have been homeschooling our kids for the past 5 or so years.

Q: When did you move to the Lakewood/Fairwood neighborhood?

Sarah: We bought a house in Lakewood Village in late 2018; before that we had been renting in Mountain View.

Q: What street do you live on?

Sarah: Lakewood Dr.

Q: Name one thing you see out your kitchen window.

Sarah: In our floor plan, the kitchen doesn't have windows (haha). But out of the living room window we can see our lemon and orange trees! My husband and I are originally from Virginia, and I was very surprised when we moved to CA to see how many homes had fruit trees in the yard.

Q: Something that is in your front yard?

Sarah: A very nice-smelling gardenia plant. I didn't know what it was called until our kids did a botany field trip last year and recognized it. I now see them in other people's yards also, and when they're blooming you can smell them all the way from the sidewalk.

Q: A sound you hear frequently in the neighborhood?

Sarah: Definitely roaring traffic noises from 101, since our yard is right up against it. It took us a couple months to get used to the noise, especially at night, but now we hardly notice it.

Q: What is something you like about living in Lakewood/Fairwood?

Sarah: I most appreciate being close to our church, which is right down the street, also in Lakewood Village. Mountain View was not that far away, but being this close has let us become even more connected with the community.

Q: And something that has changed since you moved to the neighborhood?

Sarah: I've seen more Little Free Libraries pop up, I think, which is a cute and nice trend.

Q: What are your favorite parks/things to do in Sunnyvale and/or the Bay Area?

Sarah: We really love Lakewood Park! It's easy to get to, and our kids love the water feature when it is on. Even during the pandemic when playgrounds were closed, we were able to go play in the sand of the volleyball court.

Q: Tell me a bit about your hobbies.

Sarah: I've really enjoyed helping out with our local food pantry this past year! We distribute food every Saturday morning from 10-11am, giving out food that has been donated from local grocery stores or even donated by our neighbors. It's been wonderful to meet people from the community this way, and to see people coming to donate and even help set up without being asked. If you or someone you know needs food, or if you would like to help, you can go to svrbc.org/food for more information.

Q: Any great stories to share about living in the neighborhood?

Sarah: We like walking around and exploring -- our favorite local find is Calabazas Creek east of Fairwood neighborhood; the kids really enjoy pretending to swim in it, even when it is only shin-deep (haha).

NEIGHBORHOOD SCAVENGER HUNT

Welcome to the monthly scavenger hunt. Send your name, address (to confirm that you live in the Lakewood/Fairwood neighborhood), and answers to vp2@lvnasv.org by September 30, and we will announce the winner and the correct answers in the next newsletter. If there is a tie for the winner, we will randomly select one person as the winner. The winner will get to choose from either a selection of $10 gift cards to local restaurants OR a toy from our toy prize chest.

1.What is the name of the greenbelt that runs through the Lakewood and Fairwood neighborhoods?

(a) Jon W. Christon Greenbelt
(b) John W. Christian Greenbelt
(c) John E. Christian Greenbelt
(d) John W. Kristen Greenbelt

2. What color is the fire hydrant that is at the intersection of Burntwood Ave and Bridgewood Way?

(a) White
(b) Red
(c) Orange
(d) There is no fire hydrant at this intersection

3. As you drive along Lakehaven Dr (going from Meadowlake towards Lawrence), you see a sign. What does it say?

(a) Speeding costs - $45 minimum - slow down
(b) Speeding costs - $208 minimum - go faster
(c) Speeding costs - $87 minimum - slow down
(d) Speeding costs - $397 minimum - slow down

4. Who is the manufacturer of the picnic tables that are near the playground area of Lakewood Park?

(a) Pilot Rock
(b) Chimney Rock
(c) Bay Rock
(d) Mountain Rock

5. Which of the following is NOT an exercise included in the Vita Course set-up in the Fairwood neighborhood?

(a) Log jump
(b) Parallel bars
(c) Pull up
(d) Lunges

Answers from the September scavenger hunt:

1. At the intersection of Silverlake Dr and Lakebird Dr, the fire hydrant is at the southwest corner.

(b) False

2. What is the Fairwood Elementary School mascot?

(d) Falcons

3. There's a mural at Lakewood Park near the basketball courts. Which of these is NOT included on the mural?

(d) All of the above

4. Which of the following is NOT true about the upcoming California gubernatorial recall election?

(c) The ballot consists of three questions (if Newsom should be recalled, who should succeed him if he is recalled, and if the capital should be moved from Sacramento to Redding)

5. On Crestwood Cir, how many houses have garages?

(a) All of them

CUTTING EDGE
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Miguel Rios
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I offer landscaping services including fences, concrete, pavers, house interior and exterior. Prices are reasonable. I live locally and would love the support!

Instyle Beauty Salon, located in Sunnyvale-Santa Clara, is offering readers $150 off microblading, a new and popular procedure that creates the perfect eyebrow!

Normally $450, Instyle Beauty Salon is offering readers $150 off, making it just $300 for the procedure – which also includes the touch-up visit that is recommended within 4-6 weeks of the initial procedure.

Manual microblading is a form of a semi-permanent tattoo that involves using tiny needles (instead of a tattoo gun) that make up a small blade to help deposit pigment under your skin, one by one, for natural looking hair strokes. The procedure takes about an hour to 2 hours and lasts 1.5-2 years before needing to be redone to look fresh. Topical numbing cream is used to maximize comfort. Microblading is perfect for anyone with any hair color and is tailored to each individual client.

For more information and to schedule a consultation, call or text (408) 605-2146.









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IMPORTANT NUMBERS

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Shopping Carts and Graffiti	(408) 730-7680
Animal Control	(408) 730-7178
Neighborhood Preservation	(408) 730-7610
Parks & Maintenance	(408) 730-7506
Public Safety -- General Info	(408) 730-7100
Public Safety -- Non-Emergency	(408) 730-7180

LVNA MEETING RECAP

LVNA MEETING ON SEPTEMBER 8

Last month, Dr. Moshe Lewis, M.D. joined us to share updates on the COVID-19 Delta variant, vaccinations, and the return to work/school. With the surplus of misinformation floating around out there, this was a great opportunity to hear from a trusted source for a fact-based conversation on something that I'm sure is on many of our minds. If you weren't able to join the meeting, or would just like a refresher, please check out the recording at:

https://youtu.be/oCtKqCgfg2k

UPCOMING EVENTS

OCTOBER

13 lvna monthly meeting
virtual Meet link: lvnasv.org/meeting
7:00 - 8:00 PM

TBD lvna pumpkin carving party

NOVEMBER

10 lvna monthly meeting
virtual Meet link: lvnasv.org/meeting
7:00 - 8:00 PM

For all Sunnyvale events, please refer to Sunnyvale's online calendar at https://sunnyvale.ca.gov/cals/.